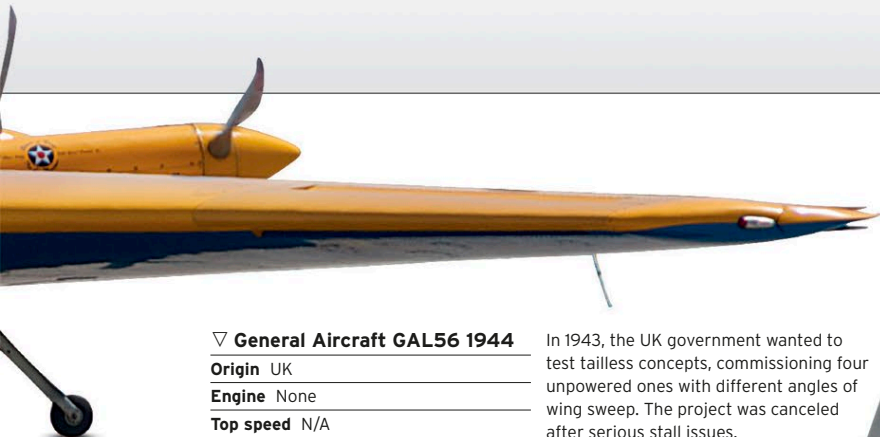




▽ General Aircraft GAL56 1944

Origin UK

Engine None

Top speed N/A

In 1943, the UK government wanted to test tailless concepts, commissioning four unpowered ones with different angles of wing sweep. The project was canceled after serious stall issues.



▷ Armstrong Whitworth AW52 1947

Origin UK

Engine 2 x 5,000 lb (2,268 kg) thrust Rolls-Royce Nene turbojet

Top speed 500 mph (805 km/h)

Three experimental aircraft were built to research a four- to six-engined flying-wing airliner concept; one was a glider and two were jet-powered. All were half of the size of the proposed airliner and were disappointing in flight.



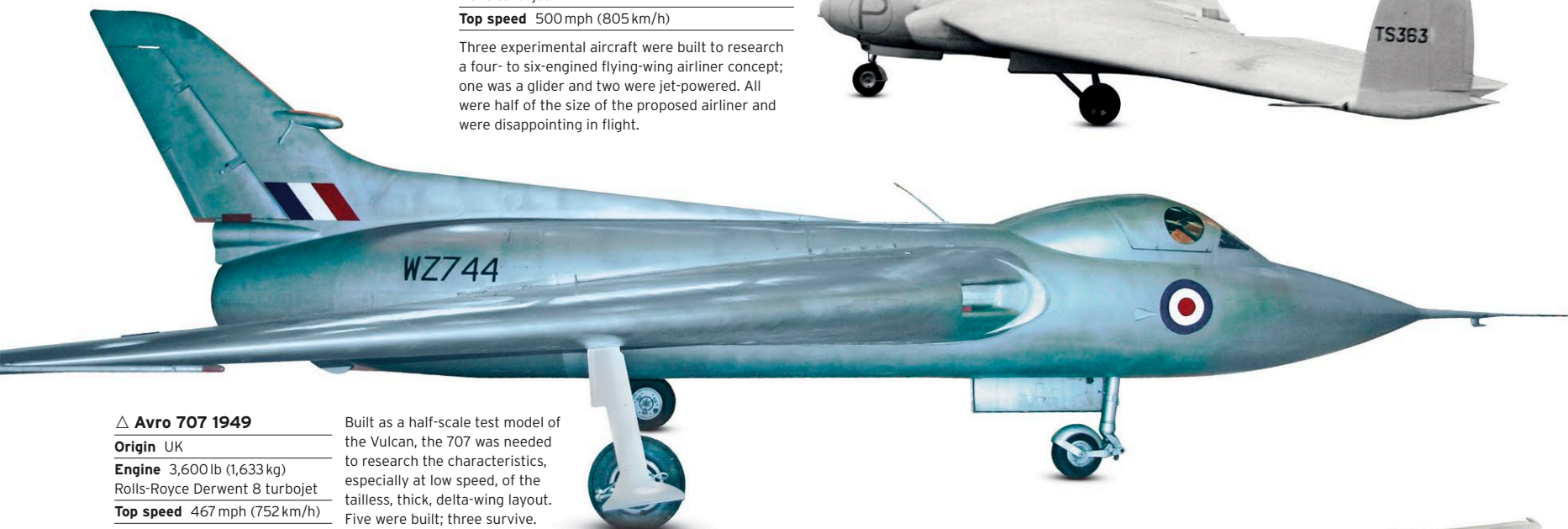
△ Martin-Baker MB5 1944

Origin UK

Engine 2,340 hp Rolls-Royce Griffon 83 supercharged liquid-cooled V12

Top speed 460 mph (740 km/h)

Using contra-rotating three-bladed propellers and the latest Rolls-Royce engine in a new steel-tube fuselage, the MB5 was said to be better than the Spitfire, but British government funds went to jet fighters instead.



△ Avro 707 1949

Origin UK

Engine 3,600 lb (1,633 kg) Rolls-Royce Derwent 8 turbojet

Top speed 467 mph (752 km/h)

Built as a half-scale test model of the Vulcan, the 707 was needed to research the characteristics, especially at low speed, of the tailless, thick, delta-wing layout. Five were built; three survive.



▽ Sud-Ouest SOM2 1949

Origin France

Engine 3,500 lb (1,588 kg) thrust Rolls-Royce Derwent 5 turbojet

Top speed 590 mph (950 km/h)

The SOM2 was built to test flight characteristics for the proposed SO4000 bomber but was used to test servos when the bomber was canceled. It was the first French aircraft to exceed 621 mph (1,000 km/h).